

MAJOR GROUPS

Each of the 6 major animal groups is introduced with an overview of its defining characteristics. These pages also cover key aspects of evolution, life cycle, and behavior.

INVERTEBRATE ANIMALS

There are so many invertebrate species that in order to provide representative coverage of the group as a whole, this book focuses on profiling the larger taxonomic groups—phylum, class, order, and family—rather than on individual species. Groups are presented in 3 ways: a brief introduction to an order or class, supported by a description of one or more constituent families, with each family illustrated by representative species (e.g., insects); a profile of a class, illustrated by species that represent distinct groups or types within it (e.g., crustaceans); a description of a phylum illustrated by a representative species of that phylum (used for minor phyla only).

LOWER-RANKED GROUPS

In many chapters, animal groups are divided into smaller groups, such as families. An introduction to each of these smaller sections describes common anatomical features. Relevant aspects of reproduction and behavior are also introduced.

SPECIES PROFILES

Over 2,000 wild animals are profiled in *The Animal Kingdom*. Every profile contains a text summary and, in most cases, a color illustration and a distribution map.

CLASSIFICATION KEY

In each animal group introduction, a color-coded panel shows the position in the animal kingdom of the group being described. The group is identified by a white outline and an

arrow. The taxonomic ranks above the group are named in the upper part of the table, while the number of lower ranks that it contains are shown below it. In some introductions, an extra Classification Note is included, to list subgroups or identify areas of debate.

LATIN NAME

The species' Latin name appears in a colored band at the beginning of each entry

DATA FIELD

Core information is provided in summary form at the beginning of each species entry. The categories vary between groups (see opposite)

COMMON NAME

The species' common name appears below the Latin name, with alternative common names given in the text profile below

LOCATION

Color maps indicate the world distribution for each species with further details given in the caption below

HABITAT SYMBOLS

These define the environment in which the animal is found (see opposite for key). Additional information may be given in the text profile below

TEXT PROFILE

Each entry has a description of the most characteristic and noteworthy features of the species

ILLUSTRATIONS

Most entries include a color photograph or artwork of the species. The animals pictured are normally adult males

Puma yagouaroundi

Jaguarundi



Location S. USA to South America

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)

Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)

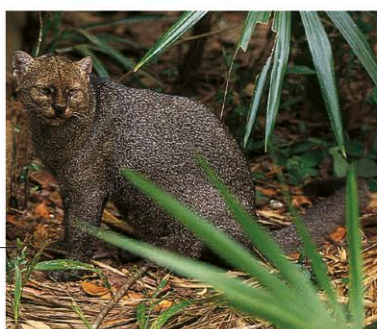
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



More mustelid than felid in overall proportions, with a pointed snout, long body, and shortish legs, the jaguarundi has several color forms of unpatterned fur, from black—mainly in forests—to pale gray-brown or red—in dry shrubland. This cat hunts by day, often on the ground, in habitats ranging from semiarid scrub to rain forest and swamp. Its main prey are birds, rodents, rabbits, reptiles, and invertebrates.



FEATURE BOXES

Profiles may include features on anatomy or species variation (blue box), behavior (yellow box), or conservation (green box)

FEATURE PROFILES

Species of particular interest are given a double-page entry. These consist of a profile with feature boxes, a spectacular, close-up photograph, and, in some cases, an action sequence.

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204

205

Puma yagouaroundi
Jaguarundi

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)
Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location S. USA to South America

Puma concolor
Puma

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)
Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location S. USA to South America

Puma tigris
Dian's clouded leopard

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)
Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location S. USA to South America

Puma pardus
Snow leopard

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)
Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location S. USA to South America

Puma leo
Jaguar

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)
Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location S. USA to South America

Puma panthera
Cheetah

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)
Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location S. USA to South America

Puma leo
Asian lion

Length 19–33 in (48.5–83.5 cm)
Tail 11–33 in (27.5–59 cm)
Weight 6½–17 lb (3–7.6 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location S. USA to South America